

PUNK AND MIDDLE-CLASS VALUES A Content Analysis

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Punk officially debuted as the "new wave" in youth subculture in the later months of 1976 through its discovery by the media as a movement with "social significance" (York, 1978; Hebdige, 1979; Baker and Coupe, 1980). During a long, hot London summer, marked by drought, economic recession, racial violence and crumbling urban neighborhoods, the British public was further distressed to learn that angry mobs of "disaffected" youth, from inner-city working-class backgrounds, had declared war on contemporary society, its institutions, and its dominant cultural values. The "punks" had effected a behavior and lifestyle in mock defiance of that which is generally associated with British formalism and conservatism. They were the antithesis of all that they felt society stood for and thus they assumed the identity of society's alienated outcasts.

Television news programs and newspapers were filled with the bizarre pictures of costumed, zombie-like, x-rated cartoon characters who stalked the twilight streets of London, hanging

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